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BSIT 301I

System integration project plan example (Applied in business)

Omni-Channel Retail Integration

A. Identify the company or enterprise

Company Name: FashionForward

FashionForward, which started as a successful clothing store with a physical location, grew by starting an independent online store and using a different, older system to manage the inventory and suppliers. This broken system has caused major problems, like the differences between online and in-store stock. For example, a shirt that is sold out in person still shows up as available on the website, which leads to customer cancellations. Customer service also has problems because they can't check if online purchases can be returned in-store. At the same time, employees have to do manual end-of-day updates on all systems. The main goal is to connect these systems so that customers and employees can have a smooth experience.

B. Identify the systems being integrated and,

Currently, FashionForward depends on a three crucial systems that need to be integrated. The Front-Office System A, an older on-premise desktop Point of Sale (POS) application that manages the in-store transactions, returns, and local inventory at the physical retail location; the Front-Office System B, a contemporary cloud-based SaaS e-commerce website that handles the online orders, customer accounts, and payments; and the Back-Office System C, a legacy Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) system (like SAP Business One or Microsoft Dynamics GP) that runs on a local server as the authoritative source for the product information, supplier data, and the master inventory counts.

C. What methods of System Integration being applied

FashionForward will use a hybrid integration approach that is customized to meet particular system requirements.

1. By deploying a central hub with connectors to the POS, e-commerce website, and ERP, it uses the **Middleware/Enterprise Application Integration (EAI)** for a real-time inventory sync and order management. This prevents point-to-point chaos by routing messages, for example, a website sale updates ERP master inventory and POS local stock almost instantly.

2. In order to handle the orders and inventory checks, the website connects via **Web Services**, utilizing APIs made available by the middleware for a standards-based, platform-independent online communication.
3. The **Portal-Oriented Integration** adds an internal web dashboard that pulls data from the POS and e-commerce APIs without direct database links. This way, the order history and returns can be seen all on one screen.
4. Finally, the **Information-Oriented Integration** is used for the first step of the data cleanup. This is said to be done through a one-time ETL (Extract, Transform, Load) process that takes accurate product data from the ERP source, changes it, and loads it into other systems so that they are all in sync.

<https://techchannel.com/networking/zos-integration-framework/#main>

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